Early Learners

Policy Council and Policy Committee

Head Start Performance Standard

§1301.3 Policy council and policy committee

(a) Establishing policy councils and policy committees. Each agency must establish and maintain a policy council responsible for the direction of the Head Start program at the agency level, and a policy committee at the delegate level. If an agency delegates operational responsibility for the entire Head Start program to one delegate agency, the policy council and policy committee may be the same body.

(b) Composition.

(1) A program must establish a policy council in accordance with section 642(c)(2)(B) of the Act, or a policy committee at the delegate level in accordance with section 642(c)(3) of the Act, as early in the program year as possible. Parents of children currently enrolled in each program option must be proportionately represented on the policy council and on the policy committee at the delegate level.

(2) The program must ensure members of the policy council, and of the policy committee at the delegate level, do not have a conflict of interest pursuant to sections 642(c)(2)(C) and 642(c)(3)(B) of the Act. Staff may not serve on the policy council or policy committee at the delegate level except parents who occasionally substitute as staff. In the case of tribal grant recipients, this exclusion applies only to tribal staff who work in areas directly related to or which directly impact administrative, fiscal, or programmatic issues.

(c) Duties and responsibilities.

(1) A policy council is responsible for activities specified at section 642(c)(2)(D) of the Act. A policy committee must approve and submit to the delegate agency its decisions in each of the following areas referenced at section 642(c)(2)(D)(i) through (vii) of the Act.

(2) A policy council, and a policy committee at the delegate level, must use ongoing monitoring results, data on school readiness goals, other information described in §1302.102, and information described in section 642(d)(2) of the Act to conduct its responsibilities.

(d) Term.

(1) A member will serve for one year.

(2) If the member intends to serve for another year, s/he must stand for re-election.

(3) The policy council, and policy committee at the delegate level, must include in its bylaws how many one-year terms, not to exceed five terms, a person may serve.

(4) A program must seat a successor policy council, or policy committee at the delegate level, before an existing policy council, or policy committee at the delegate level, may be dissolved.

(e) Reimbursement. A program must enable low-income members to participate fully in their policy council or policy committee responsibilities by providing, if necessary, reimbursements for reasonable expenses incurred by the low-income members.

Policy

PPS Early Learners will establish a parent policy council in accordance with the Head Start Performance Standards, program grant requirements, and the current approved Policy Council Bylaws.

Procedure

1. Composition of the Policy Council will be determined during the first site-level family gathering. Each site will elect at least one representative per site, with no more than two representatives per classroom. Policy Council membership is established by October 31st annually, PPS employees and members of their immediate family are prohibited from serving on Policy Council.
2. Roles and responsibilities of the Policy Council will include, but not be limited to, approval and submission to the Governing Body decisions about each of the following activities:
   A. Activities to support the active involvement of parents in supporting program operations, including policies to ensure that the program, including the Head Start agency, is responsive to community and parent needs.
   B. Program recruitment, selection and enrollment priorities.
   C. Applications for funding and amendments to applications for funding for programs under this subchapter, prior to submission of applications described in this clause.
   D. Budget planning for program expenditures, including policies for reimbursement and participation in Policy Council activities.
   E. Bylaws for the operation of the Policy Council.
   F. Program personnel policies and decisions regarding the employment of program staff, consistent with Section 642(c) paragraph (1)(E)(lX) of the Head Start Act, including standards of conduct for program staff, contractors, and volunteers and criteria for the employment and dismissal of program staff.
   G. Developing procedures for how members of the Policy Council will be selected.
   H. Recommendations on the selection of delegate agencies and the service areas for such agencies.
   I. Approve the amount and the use of the Parent Activity Funds that are allocated to the Policy Council.
3. Caregivers are asked to complete their Oct–Oct term and continue in a policy council role until new parents are elected. No caregiver shall serve more than five consecutive terms on the Policy Council.
4. Reimbursement
   A. Childcare will be provided so parents can participate in Policy Council and parent committees.
   B. Bus tickets provided as needed.
   C. Program will cover all costs of members attending state/regional training.
   D. Parents will receive reimbursement for reasonable and agreed upon expenses
   E. Appropriate expense receipts must be maintained.

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